Gaurav M.

Brand & Product Strategy | Consumer Brands, Creative, Content & Community

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200M+	**200K → 800K+**	**$2.65M → $13.5M**	**100M+**
H&R Block India reach	FITTR community, 70+ countries	FITTR company ARR in 3 years	Fitness Made Forever reach

PROFILE

I started my career as a primary researcher, and research is still where my work begins. I find the gap between how founders think their brand is seen and how people actually see it, build the insight, set the design and copy direction, and scale it across every touchpoint. Over 12+ years at FITTR, H&R Block, Ketto and TransPerfect Paybooks, I have repositioned brands, directed films and campaigns across TV, OTT, cinema and outdoor, built content, social and community engines, and hired the teams that run them.

01 RESEARCH	**02** INSIGHT	**03** CREATIVE DIRECTION	**04** TOUCHPOINTS	**05** SCALE

CORE EXPERTISE

Brand Strategy & Positioning · Rebranding & Repositioning · Creative Direction · Integrated Campaigns (TV, OTT, Cinema, OOH, Digital) · Brand Films · Content Marketing & Content Libraries · Social Media Growth & Virality · Community Building · Celebrity & Influencer Partnerships · Performance Marketing · Consumer Research & Insight · D2C & App Growth · CRM & Lifecycle · Events & Activations · Team Building & Agency Management

EXPERIENCE

TransPerfect Paybooks | Senior Manager, Brand & Marketing

MAY 2023 TO PRESENT

Global people management brand extension of TransPerfect, the world's largest language services and technology company.

- Repositioned Paybooks upmarket on 70 ICP interviews and an NPS programme across 600 clients. Average MRR per new India client rose from $37 to $143 in two years.
- Built the Global People Solution (EOR, Global HCM, Multi-country Payroll) across 43 countries, from naming and brand architecture to plans, packaging and GTM, and onboarded the first two clients myself.
- Moved 290 legacy India clients to current plans for $1M in added ARR. Average client lifespan grew from 3Y 8M to 4Y 6M.
- Led a full rebrand with new WhatsApp and LinkedIn channels. India CAC fell from $680 to $545, with brand-led acquisition at $454 per client.
- Grew LinkedIn followers from 1,600 to 16,000+ through the Humans of Paybooks employer brand series, and built an AI prospecting engine that opened 9 pipelines worth nearly $500K for a $68 build.

Independent Brand Consulting | Brand Strategist

2023 TO 2025

Brand foundations for founders across wellness, home essentials and fintech.

- Crystal Life (2025): primary research across major metros for a kitchen and home brand entering food storage against Gladware and Ziplock. Named the range Podware and the product Pod; launch due 2027.
- FAMLI (2025): brand foundation and positioning for a family-wealth fintech app, which reached 1,000+ users in a three-month beta.
- Mountainor (2023): brand foundation, wellness positioning, visual identity, packaging, tone of voice and a WhatsApp resell funnel for a health and personal care brand.

FITTR | Brand Manager

MAR 2020 TO MAY 2023

India's largest online fitness and nutrition platform: a B2C app marketplace for coaching, training and community.

- Repositioned FITTR from a six-pack brand to holistic, preventive health and wellbeing for everyone, through five-type audience segmentation, positioning, tonality and the 2021 rebrand.
- Directed Fitness Made Forever, FITTR's brand film, from my creative brief to TV, OTT, cinema, print, outdoor and digital: 100M+ reach on a $1.3M budget, extended with KL Rahul.
- Scaled the Transformation Challenge (Seasons 10 to 18) beyond the community: 45M+ reach, 2M+ app downloads and about 20% of customer acquisition, with Suniel Shetty and Vidyut Jammwal.

- Grew the community from 200K to 800K+ across 70+ countries at $6 per member, with Nas Daily helping take it beyond India. Ran 1 mega, 3 to 5 medium and 30+ local events a year, including Connect Fest with Milind Soman and Mandira Bedi.
- Inherited a team of 4 and hired 16 across content, social, design, video, community, performance, SEO, PR, CRM and analytics, within a 30-person marketing function. Managed about $4.3M a year in spend and 50+ influencers.
- Co-created FITTR Online PT and grew it to 24% of revenue, 60% to 70% of it from outside India. Content libraries (1M+ foods, 10K+ recipes, 1,000+ videos) lifted DAU 40%, MAU 25% and in-app engagement 340%. Wrote the India GTM for FITTR HART: $900K in year one.
- Led the FITTR Ambassador Program: 700 coaches enabled, coach-driven enrollment up 35% year on year.

Ketto | Brand Strategy Manager — SEP 2019 TO FEB 2020

India's leading crowdfunding platform for medical and social causes.

- Conceived and produced PodcastMD with co-founder Kunal Kapoor: 12 survivor episodes, 10M+ streams and 100+ letters from patients.
- Launched a treatment cost estimator for 100+ illnesses. 30% of users asked to start a campaign, and estimator-led campaigns raised $430K+ in three months.
- Brought in 10+ sports and Bollywood celebrities, and built hospital and NGO partnerships with offline kiosks.

H&R Block India | Junior Executive to Assistant Manager, Brand Communication — MAR 2015 TO SEP 2019

US-headquartered tax preparation company in 10+ countries. India ran B2C and B2B tax filing with a retail office network.

- Owned India brand, campaigns and content end to end, including Tax Samasya Unlock, #BeTheBoss and the Tax Pledge. Campaigns and content reached 200M+ people across India.
- Built the Content Lab in an empty meeting room (team of 4 plus 20 interns, 500+ videos) and the Knowledge Center (500+ articles). Organic traffic grew from under 50K to 30M per season, with 50%+ category search share and about 25% of revenue.
- Led marketing for 8 retail offices on $1.2M to $1.5M per season across digital, tech parks, billboards, radio, cinema and flash mobs. Managed 800+ alliances, launched earlyGST (500+ businesses in year one) and GST Made Simple (40+ episodes).
- Supported US campaigns including Get Your Taxes Won (Super Bowl, Jon Hamm) with Fallon: creative adaptation, media planning, spend monitoring and impact tracking. Promoted 3 times in 4.5 years.

SalesNXT | Primary Researcher to AM, Business Development — JUL 2014 TO MAR 2015

B2B primary research firm serving clients across the US, UK, Australia and Canada.

- Ran one-on-one and group video studies and survey research for brands across major economies, then moved into sales when research conversations turned into clients.

WORK I DIRECTED



Fitness Made Forever



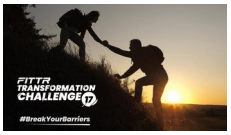
Challenge 13



Challenge 15



Challenge 16



Challenge 17


H&R Block India

Every case study, with the research, the creative, the films and the numbers: mishrawrites.com/case-studies.html

AWARDS

- Marketing Guru Award (Global), H&R Block, 2018, chosen from 20 nominations across 5 countries
- H&R Block: Global Rising Star Award · Hall of Fame Award · Outstanding Contribution Award for India Operations
- World Digital Marketing Congress: Best Content Marketing Video Series · Best Social Media Marketing Campaign · Global Youth Forum: Best Use of Facebook · DIGIXX: Social Awareness Award

EDUCATION

MBA | Balaji Institute of Technology & Management, Pune — 2012 TO 2014

BBA | NSHM Knowledge Campus — 2009 TO 2012

TOOLS

CRM & lifecycle: CleverTap, WebEngage, HubSpot, Salesforce, Zoho, Marketo, Microsoft Dynamics 365, Capillary, Mailchimp, Brevo
SEO & growth: Semrush, Surfer SEO, Unbounce, Apollo Design: Canva AI: Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity